

Lesson 10. Grammar: Changing Direct Interrogative and Imperative Speech into Reported Speech.

Topic: History of medicine.



Changing Direct Interrogative Speech into Reported Speech

While converting an interrogative sentence into indirect form, following changes are made:

1. Change the reporting verb “said” or “told” into “asked” or “inquired”.
2. Use “if” or “whether” instead of “that” to introduce the Reported Speech if it does not begin with the question word like Who/ Where/How/ what etc.
3. No conjunction is required when the question is introduced by a question word.



Direct speech: On the very first date, she asked me, "Have you kissed a girl before?"

Indirect speech: On the very first date, she asked me if I had kissed anyone.

Direct speech: The other night, Jon asked me, "Are you taking drugs?"

Indirect speech: The other night, Jon asked me if I was taking drugs.

Direct speech: He said, "What can I do for you?"

Indirect speech: He asked what he could do for me.

Direct speech: She said to us, "What do you think of yourselves?"

Indirect speech: She asked us what we thought of ourselves.

4. The interrogative form is changed into a statement.



Changing Direct Imperative Speech into Reported Speech

While converting an imperative sentence into indirect speech, the following changes are made:

1. The reporting verb “said” or “told” is changed into the verb indicating command, request, advice, etc. as required by the sense.
2. No conjunction is used. Use “to” before the verb.

Direct Speech	He said, “Lie down slowly, Tom.”
Indirect Speech	He told Tom to lie down slowly.
Direct Speech	“Don’t swim out too far, boys,” said the coach.
Indirect Speech	The coach warned the boys not to swim out too far.
Direct Speech	The boy said to his friend, “Please play that tune again.”
Indirect Speech	The boy requested his friend to play that tune again.
Direct Speech	“Order in Court,” said the judge to the people in the court.
Indirect Speech	The judge commanded the people in the court to keep order.
Direct Speech	“Don’t write on the wall!” he said to May.
Indirect Speech	He ordered May not to write on the wall.
Direct Speech	“Please, please don’t take any risks,” said his wife.
Indirect Speech	His wife begged him not to take any risks.

